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Graduate Studies

University at Albany, SUNY

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

2020 - present

Thesis Title: "Essays in Health Economics"

References:

Professor Pinka Chatterji

Department of Economics
University at Albany, SUNY
Hudson, Room 211B, Albany, NY 12222
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Professor Chun-Yu Ho

Department of Economics
University at Albany, SUNY
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Professor Baris K. Yörük

Department of Economics
University at Albany, SUNY
Hudson, Room 209, Albany, NY 12222
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Professor James A Swartz

Jane Addams College of Social Work
University of Illinois, Chicago
1040 W. Harrison Street, MC 309, Chicago, IL 60607
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Prior Studies

Xiamen University

M.A. Economics

Sept 2017 - June 2020

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics

B.M. International Business

Sept 2013 - June 2017

Research Fields

Primary Interests: Health Economics

Secondary Interests: Applied Econometrics; Public Economics

Publications

Peer Reviewed Articles and Reports:

- Li N, Borate SN, Zhang K, et al. (2025). [Mapping Disparities in Access to Lecanemab in Georgia. *Alzheimer's & Dementia*, 21:e70100.](#)
- Yörük, B. K., & Han, Y. (2024). [Age-based health insurance coverage policies and mental health. *Journal of Population Economics*, 37\(2\), 1-26.](#)
- Han, Y., & Yörük, B. K. (2024). [How Effective were COVID-19-related State Policies in US to Mitigate Alcohol Sales? *Journal of Studies on Alcohol and Drugs*, jsad-24.](#)
- Swartz, J. A., Franceschini, D., Han, Y. & Scamperle, K (September 2024). [2024 Illinois Cannabis Regulation and Tax Act annual evaluation.](#) Chicago, IL: Illinois Department of Human Services, Division of Substance Use Prevention and Recovery.

- Swartz, J. A., Franceschini, D., Scamperle, K., Han, Y. & Madan, S. (July 2023). **2023 Illinois Cannabis Regulation and Tax Act annual evaluation.** Chicago, IL: Illinois Department of Human Services, Division of Substance Use Prevention and Recovery.

Book Chapters:

- Han, Y., & Zhu, J. (2022). **Demand for Labour Post–Covid-19: The Case of China.** In Political, Economic And Social Dimensions Of Labour Markets: A Global Insight (pp. 245-275).

Research Papers

Job market paper:

“Drug Diffusion through Clinical Trial Sites: Evidence from Physician Prescribing of New Cancer Drugs”

Abstract: Clinical trials benefit patients directly by providing novel treatments, but little is known about the indirect effects of clinical trials on physician prescribing. In this study, we test whether exposure to a clinical trial of a new drug in a physician’s local geographic area affects the physician’s propensity to prescribe the drug. Utilizing the Medicare Part D prescribing patterns of more than 10,000 physicians across 29 new cancer drugs approved by the US Food and Drug Administration between 2014 and 2019, we find that exposure to clinical trials of new cancer drugs increases the likelihood that physicians prescribe these drugs by 0.18 percentage points, representing a 14% increase relative to the average prescribing rate. Notably, the effects are more pronounced for physicians graduating from higher-ranked medical schools, for more experienced physicians, and for physicians practicing in metropolitan areas. Further, our results suggest that the exposure to clinical trials reduces the physicians’ information acquisition cost of new cancer drugs. Specifically, the cost can be reduced by proximities to trial sites and to the first author of pivotal trial and by affiliation with trial sites.

Papers under review:

- **“Rural-Urban Disparities in Geographical Access to Preferred Pharmacy Networks in Medicare Part D, 2010-2020”** with Pinka Chatterji and Chun-Yu Ho.
- **“Did the Paycheck Protection Program affect disability applications during the COVID-19 pandemic?”** with Pinka Chatterji, Kajal Lahiri, Jinman Pang, Cheng Yang and Yimeng Yin (Grant NO. RDR18000003 from the US Social Security Administration (SSA) funded as part of the Retirement and Disability Research Consortium).
- **“Does consolidation in insurer markets affect insurance enrollment and drug expenditures? Evidence from Medicare Part D”** with Pinka Chatterji, Chun-Yu Ho, Tao Jin and Yichuan Wang.

Working papers:

- **“Explaining Inter-State Variation in Disability Applications During the COVID-19 Pandemic”** with Pinka Chatterji, Kajal Lahiri, Jinman Pang, Cheng Yang and Yimeng Yin (NBER RDRC Working Paper 22-02, featured in the Bulletin on Retirement and Disability (NBER)).
- **“Decomposing Income Related Disability Inequality: the Role of Job Demands”** with Pinka Chatterji and Chun-Yu Ho.
- **“Cannabis/Opioid Use & Poisoning among Medicare/Medicaid patients”** with James A Swartz.
- **“Spatiotemporal Analysis - Exploring the effect of Cannabis Dispensaries proximity on Opioid/Cannabis Use Disorder/Poisoning”** with James A Swartz.

Teaching Experiences

Instructor, University at Albany, SUNY <i>Intermediate Macroeconomics</i>	July 2024 - Aug 2024, Online <i>Undergraduate</i>
Teaching Assistant, University at Albany, SUNY <i>Intermediate Microeconomics</i>	Jan 2023 - May 2023 <i>Undergraduate</i>
Instructor, University at Albany, SUNY <i>Principles of Economics I: Microeconomics</i>	Aug 2022 - Dec 2022 <i>Undergraduate</i>
Teaching Assistant, University at Albany, SUNY <i>Special Topics in Economics</i>	Jan 2022 - May 2022 <i>Undergraduate & Graduate</i>
Teaching Assistant, University at Albany, SUNY <i>Environmental Economics</i>	Aug 2021 - Dec 2021 <i>Undergraduate & Graduate</i>
Tutor, University at Albany, SUNY <i>Principles of Economics I: Microeconomics; Principles of Economics I: Macroeconomics</i>	Jan 2021 - May 2021 <i>Undergraduate</i>

Seminar/ Conference Presentations

- 2025 Eastern Economic Association Conference
- 2024 APPAM Fall Research Conference
- 2024 Southern Economic Association Conference
- 2024 Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists
- 2024 FDA brown-bag presentation
- 2024 Eastern Economic Association Conference
- 2023 Southern Economic Association Conference

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships

- 2024 GSA Professional Development Grant
- 2024 Karen R. Hitchcock New Frontiers Fund Award
- 2023 Honorable mention, Pong S. Lee Award for best third-year paper, University at Albany
- 2020-2023, Graduate Assistantship, University at Albany
- 2017 Outstanding Graduates, Southwestern University of Finance and Economics
- 2013 - 2017 First-class Scholarship, Southwestern University of Finance and Economics
- 2016 Honorable Mention team, Mathematical Contest in Modeling
- 2016 First Prize team, 4th "TipDM" National Challenge in Data Mining

Specialized Skills

- **Certifications:** Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) Level III Passed.
- **Programs and Statistics Software:** STATA; R; MATLAB; LaTeX; GIS; MS-Office; EViews; SPSS; Python; SAS; SQL; Git